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# 1. Introduction

**(1) What is the topic of your project?** The topic I selected for my final project is the relationship between regime type and armed conflict between states.

**(2) What is the research question?**[1] The concrete research question of this project is:

(2.1.) How does the regime type of states impact their likelihood of waging war?

**(3) Why do you think that your topic/research question is of relevance?** This question is of outmost relevance because of the return of interstate war as exemplified by (empirical example here) and the democratic back-sliding that has been occurring across multiple countries in the last decades (author x or institute). Therefore, understanding the relationship between regime type and the outbreak of war could illuminate about the prospects for international peace or war in a world in which political regimes are changing.

**/4) What is the hypothesis related to your research question?** Previous work, i.e. (author x and author z) examining the relationship between the regime type of states and their proclivity to fight has argued that democratic regimes are less likely to wage war with one another. This is **because** *(insert here a concise explanation about how X relates to Y).* Accordingly, this idea/argument can be summarized in the following hypothesis:

**H:** ***State-dyads characterized by their similarity in democratic regime are associated with a low likelihood of war outbreak.***

**(5) What is the Y (dependent variable) and X (independent variable) in the hypothesis?** This hypothesis understands the regime type of states, particularly the shared characteristic of a democratic regime as the independent variable and war outbreak between states as the dependent variable**.**

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[1] **If you have a specialized research question due to i.e. focusing only on a particular region, state or dyad, please include this research question as well.**

**(6) What is the level of analysis of the hypothesis?** This relationship is elaborated (and has been constantly tested, see author y) at the dyadic level of analysis.

**(7) How is the remainder of your document structured?** In the remainder of this document, I will focus on a research design describing the construction of a sample appropriate to test this hypothesis at the dyadic level of analysis, provide an overview of the sample structure and the rationale behind the selection of data. Next, I will present descriptive statistics concerning the variation in regime type and the variation in the outbreak of war in the sample, as well as present a descriptive bivariate analysis examining the relationship between regime type and war outbreak. The last section discusses the results of the empirical analysis by relating them with the hypothesis previously stating and concludes.

## 2. Research Design

**What are you going to do in this section?** In the following, I will first clarify the rationale behind the data selection and sample construction. Second, I will present the operationalization of the dependent and independent variable. In this step, I will describe the variation in both variables with the help of measures of central tendency and dispersion – including corresponding visualizations and a table with summary statistics. Lastly, I will show the extent to which my dependent and independent variable are associated via the implementation of a descriptive bivariate analysis.

### 2.1. Sample construction and data selection

**(1)Which sample do you construct?** I construct an undirected-dyad-year sample.

**(2)How is the sample constructed?** The sample is based on the list of states members of the international system provided by the COW, and I use the peacesciencer R package developed by Miller (2022) to construct it.

**(3)How many observations does your sample have – sample size?** The sample size is $n = xxxxx$ undirected dyad-years.

**(4)Is your sample cross-sectional, longitudinal or panel structured?** The sample has a panel structure comprised of 20,604 dyads and 201 years (from 1816 to 2016).

**(5)What is the unit of analysis?** The unit of analysis is the undirected dyad-year.

**(6)How can you make your units identifiable?** The sample includes two "ID" variables: One called "name_dyad_id" specifying the dyad label for each individual dyad of states and one called "name_dyad_year_id," including the year of the observation.

**(7)What are your data sources?** The outbreak of war as recorded by the COW institute (version xxxx) and democratic-regime values from Polity IV (version yxyyy).

**(8)Why did you choose these data sources and not others?**

### 2.2. Operationalization of the Dependent Variable (Y): War Outbreak

**What is the name of this variable in your data?**

**What is your selected operationalization?**

**Why did you choose/create this operationalization and not another?**

**What is the level of measurement of the variable?**

**According to the level of measurement, which statistics do you choose to describe the central tendency and dispersion of Y?**

**What do these statistics tell you about Y?**

**Visualization 1: Describing the variation of Y. Figures have a meaningful title. If it is of your own construction (as it should), no source needed. If not, source needed.**

**→Interpret the visualization:**

**Why did you choose this visualization and not others?**

**What does the visualization tell you about Y?**

### 2.3. Operationalization of the Independent Variable (X): Regime Type

**What is the name of this variable in your data?**

**What is your selected operationalization?**

**Why did you choose/create this operationalization and not another?**

**What is the level of measurement of the variable?**

**According to the level of measurement, which statistics do you choose to describe the central tendency and dispersion of X?**

**What do these statistics tell you about X?**

**Visualization 2: Describing the variation of Y. Figures have a meaningful title. If it is of your own construction (as it should), no source needed. If not, source needed.**

**→Interpret the visualization:**

**Why did you choose this visualization and not others?**

**What does the visualization tell you about X?**

**Summary table of the variables (X & Y) with your chosen descriptive statistics:**

### 2.4. Describing the relationship between X and Y

**According to the level of measurement of both X and Y, which method do you choose to assess their relationship?**

**What does this method tell you about the relationship between X and Y?**

**Visualization 3: Bivariate relationship between X and Y. Figures have a meaningful title. If it is of your own construction (as it should), no source needed. If not, source needed.**

**→Interpret the visualization:**

**Why did you choose this visualization and not others?**

**What does the visualization tell you about the relationship between X and Y?**

## 3. Discussion

**Link results with hypothesis (you can remove this comment):**

**Do you find evidence to corroborate the hypothesis?**

**Is this evidence robust?**

**Are your findings contrary to the hypothesis? Different than you expected?**

**If yes, why may this be the case? Measurement? Sample? Case selection? Confounding?**

## 4. Conclusion

**What was your project about?**

**Which hypothesis did you test using which data?**

**Which statistics/procedures did you choose for the bivariate analysis, and what did you find?**

**What could be a potential avenue for future research based on what you found?**

## Resources

Please integrate a bibliography of **all the resources that you have used** to produce your project! There are multiple 'citation styles which you can choose from (e.g. APA, Chicago, Harvard, etc). Choose the one that you feel comfortable using. The **only requirement** is that the **citation style is consistent across the whole document** – including in-text citations and the resources section. **An example of using Chicago for a scientific article**:

Miller, Steven V. "{peacesciencer}: An R package for quantitative peace science research." *Conflict Management and Peace Science* 39, no. 6 (2022): 755-779.

### Declaration of academic integrity/of originality

Please include a signed declaration of academic integrity. A possible text can be found at https://www.lmu.de/isc/en/isc-studi-wiki/forms-and-templates/ or/and https://cms-cdn.lmu.de/media/50-zentren/isc-informations-und-servicecenter-wirtschaftswissenschaftliche-pruefungen/downloads/formulare-und-vorlagen/eidesstattliche-erklaerung-fuer-seminar-abschlussarbeiten.pdf